

Does GenAI Deplete Us? The Effects of Using GenAI for Writing on Identity and Ego Depletion

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Abstract

GenAI enhances writing tasks by conserving users' cognitive resources, but this convenience may diminish users' connection to the content. Through two experiments, this study explores how reliance on GenAI affects cognitive depletion, identity reflection, prompting behaviors, and attitudes toward created content and GenAI, emphasizing the risk of uncritical trust in AI-generated content due to cognitive fatigue. Study 1 employed a Be-task to deplete cognitive resources, revealing that user involvement in writing enhances perceived identity reflection, which leads to greater persistence in unsolvable tasks and higher credibility and behavioral trust in AI. Study 2, using an email-writing task with greater ecological validity, showed the effect of user involvement on credibility. Practically, these findings suggest that AI interfaces should balance cognitive assistance with fostering user agency. Promoting active user engagement in content creation can improve credibility and trust while mitigating over-reliance on AI.

CCS Concepts

• **Applied computing** → **Psychology**; • **Human-centered computing** → *Empirical studies in HCI*; Natural language interfaces.

Keywords

Generative AI, Writing Task, Ego Depletion, Cognitive Resources, Perceived Identity Reflection, Prompting

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1 Introduction

In many domains, either professional or not-work related, Large Language Models (LLMs) based generative artificial intelligence (GenAI) has become a significant tool for creating media content or communicator itself (i.e., when people attempt to communicate

with AI) [29]. GenAI is capable of creating text, images, and, of course, computer languages such as codes, which greatly assist users' tasks. GenAI users also utilize this tool in their daily lives, such as writing emails and essays and crafting profiles for social media or dating apps. In particular, GenAI's creative and adaptive capabilities have evolved to interpret users' true intentions and help them express their ideas and thoughts through AI-created content [14].

One key advantage of using GenAI in content creation is that it allows users to conserve cognitive resources by reducing the effort required to create content. It is often argued that one's mental resources are limited and run out after use [3, 4, 31]. Specifically, engaging in self-control (e.g., persistence on difficult tasks, suppression of emotions, etc.) consumes and depletes a finite inner resource, resulting in a state of ego depletion—the temporary decrease in one's ability or willingness to engage in intentional actions due to prior exertion of self-control [4]. When one's cognitive resources are depleted, they often fail in the subsequent self-control efforts [3].

In this aspect, GenAI can be especially helpful in writing. Writing is a task that requires enormous mental resources and self-control [15]. Writers must take the time to carefully select and refine their words to express their intentions and ideas clearly, all while anticipating how the reader might interpret their message [22]. GenAI can tremendously ease the cognitive burden on writers by supporting them throughout the writing process—providing ideas, building arguments, correcting grammar, and refining text [23, 33].

Ironically, this alleviation of cognitive reduction can result in losing the “self” in their writing. Studies show that employing GenAI in writing can reduce writers' sense of authorship over their work [7], potentially diminishing their sense of accomplishment as well [17]. Writers worry that using GenAI, even just considering its suggestions, could compromise their authenticity by failing to fully capture their unique identity [9]. Incorporating GenAI into writing reduces cognitive load at the cost of diminishing users' identity in the content. Conversely, greater user involvement allows users to embed their identity into the work, which requires a significant amount of cognitive effort. Thus, we suggest the following hypothesis (H):

H1 *The more individuals use GenAI, the less they will experience ego depletion, mediated by a decreased level of perceived identity reflection.*

Conversely, despite its convenience, users sometimes prefer to be involved in the generation process of AI. Even when AI performs well, they often perceive it as less credible if they are not involved in the creation process [16]. Similarly, when GenAI requires users

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to sustain minimal user involvement, individuals may perceive that their identity is not well reflected by their outcomes, leading to lower perceptions of credibility. Thus, we propose:

H2 *The more individuals use GenAI, the less they will place (a) credibility in their written content and (b) behavioral trust in the AI, mediated by a decreased level of perceived identity reflection.*

While the use of GenAI in content creation can significantly reduce cognitive load and alleviate the need for self-regulatory resources, thereby preventing ego depletion—a benefit often regarded as positive, this reduced cognitive and self-control effort may inadvertently lead users to engage less critically with the results produced by GenAI due to the diminished sense of self-identity in the generated content. In turn, they may be less inclined to refine prompts or double-check outputs, instead relying carelessly on the AI's suggestions [18]. This contingent over-trust can foster an uncritical reliance on GenAI, potentially overlooking errors or biases in its output [32]. Therefore, we propose:

H3 *The more individuals use GenAI, the less they will refine the subsequent prompt (i.e., fewer words will be in user prompts), mediated by a decreased level of perceived identity reflection.*

To this end, this study investigates the cognitive and psychological mechanism by conducting two experiments with one factor (Use of GenAI in Content Writing: AI vs. Tandem vs. Self) between-subject design with two different tasks: essay writing by restricting Be Verbs (Study 1) and email writing in high-involvement situations (Study 2).

2 Study 1

Study 1 was a between-subjects design experiment with three conditions manipulating the use of GenAI in writing content: AI, Tandem, and Self.

2.1 Participant

Study 1 recruited 97 participants who live in the US through ProLific, an online participant recruitment pool. Two participants were excluded because the absolute value of the z score of their survey duration surpassed 3.5, resulting in a final sample size of 95. Among the participants, 52.6 percent identified as male, while 46.3 percent identified as female. Additionally, 1.1 percent preferred not to disclose their gender. In terms of race, 58.9 percent identified as White, while 29.5 percent identified as Black or African American. 5.3 percent of participants identified as Asian, while 6.3 percent identified as Other. Participants' ages ranged from 18 to 69, with an average age of 35.45 years ($SD = 11.78$).

2.2 Experimental Procedure

After consenting to the research, participants were informed that they would have a writing task. To deplete the participants' cognitive resources, we used a variation of attention essay, one of the most commonly used manipulation tasks of ego depletion (see [5]), which we named "*Be-task*." In this task, participants wrote an essay describing the details of the happiest moment in their lives, without using Be verbs (e.g., "am," "are," "is," "was," "were," "been," and "being").

While all the participants got the Be-task, those in the Self group wrote the essay on their own without the help of GenAI (full depletion expected), those in the AI group generated the writing using GenAI (no depletion expected), and those in the tandem condition used GenAI but drafted the essay before using it (partial depletion expected). After the interaction, participants answered a short questionnaire with 7 items asking to what extent they imbued their identity to the essay. After the writing task and short survey, all participants engaged in an unsolvable anagram task to measure the depletion (see 2.3 Stimuli for the detail). This task demands significant self-control resources to persist through frustration and continue despite experiencing repeated failures [13]. After this, participants in AI and tandem conditions received one more chance of prompting AI to improve their essays. Finally, participants in the AI and Tandem conditions completed a questionnaire assessing credibility of AI and behavioral trust in it.

2.3 Stimuli

AI Writing Assistant. We created an AI writing assistant using the Flask web framework and the GPT-4 OpenAI API (*Temperature* = 0.01, *Top P* = 1.00) to ensure highly deterministic and predictable responses. The assistant was given the following instruction: "You are a helpful AI writing assistant." Then, it was embedded in the Qualtrics survey. This approach provided a controlled yet realistic conversational agent capable of delivering consistent interactions across experimental conditions.

Unsolvable Anagram. The unsolvable anagram is one of the most frequently used outcome tasks in the ego depletion studies (see [5]). Participants had to rearrange "A" "N" "B" "I" "T" to form a meaningful word with five characters, which is impossible. Participants were informed that they could spend as much or as little time as they deemed necessary on the anagram task. The arrow button to proceed with the survey appeared after 5 seconds. This task demands significant self-control resources to persist through frustration and continues despite experiencing repeated failures [13].

2.4 Measures

Perceived Identity Reflection. Perceived Identity Reflection was measured on a 7-point Likert scale (1 – strongly disagree, 7 – strongly agree) using 7 items created by [13] and modified based on the current study context. The items include "I think the essay is a true representation of who I am," "I feel the essay represents my core personal values," "If someone ridiculed my essay, I would feel irritated," "My essay reminds me of who I am," "I don't really have too many feelings about my essay (reverse coded)," "If someone praised my essay, I would feel somewhat praised myself," and "If someone destroyed my essay, I would feel a little bit personally attacked" ($M = 4.81$, $SD = 1.25$, *Cronbach's alpha* (α) = .88).

Writing Credibility. Credibility was measured on a 7-point Likert scale (1 – strongly disagree, 7 – strongly agree) using 3 adjectives created by [1]. The adjectives are "authentic," "accurate," and "believable" ($M = 5.48$, $SD = 1.51$, $\alpha = .93$).

Behavioral Trust. Behavioral trust was measured on a 7-point Likert scale (1 – strongly disagree, 7 – strongly agree) using 3 items created by [2] and modified based on the current study context. The items include "I intend to continue using this AI in the future," "I

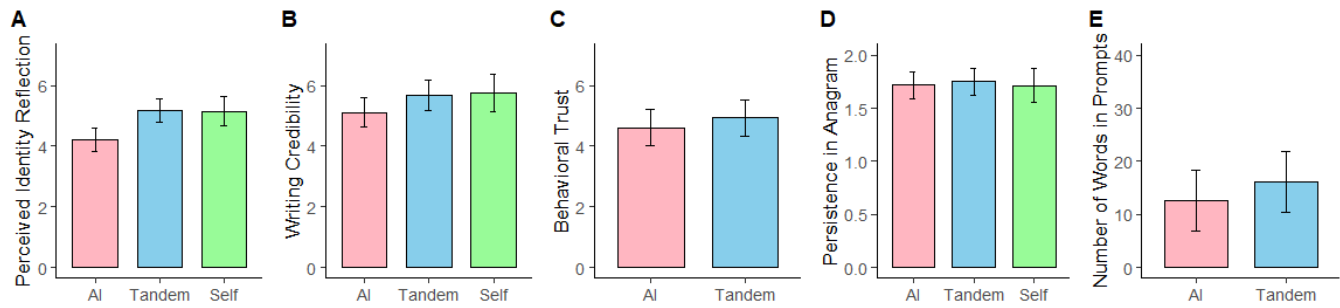


Figure 1: Study 1 Results. Values are estimated marginal means of the measures by experimental conditions. Error bars indicate 95% confidence interval.

will strongly recommend others to use this AI for creating a profile,” and “I will always try to use this AI in my daily life” ($M = 4.77$, $SD = 1.78$, $\alpha = .94$).

Persistence in an Unsolvable Anagram. The level of ego depletion was measured through the duration that participants spent in the unsolvable anagram task [13]. The online survey software recorded the time each participant spent on the anagram page. The data were log-transformed after subtracting 5 seconds from the original duration since the arrow button to proceed with the survey became visible after a 5-second delay ($M = 1.73$, $SD = 0.38$).

Number of Words in Prompts. The number of words in participants’ prompts was also counted to see how the self-control resource impacted users’ prompting activity after the writing task ($M = 14.40$, $SD = 17.06$).

2.5 Results

To investigate the research questions, the current study analyzed the main effects of writing task sources using a series of ANOVAs and PROCESS Macro Model 4. The p-values of the post-hoc tests were adjusted using the Bonferroni Correction.

2.5.1 Main Effects. According to a series of ANOVAs, the use of GenAI in the writing task showed significant differences in perceived identity reflection $F(2, 92) = 7.22$, $p = .001$, $partial \eta^2 = .14$. Participants in Tandem group showed the highest level of perceived identity reflection ($M = 5.19$, $SD = 1.10$), and participants in Self ($M = 5.14$, $SD = 1.13$) and AI followed ($M = 4.22$, $SD = 1.28$). This finding indicates that users’ efforts to create content increased perceived identity reflection. The difference between AI condition and Self condition was significant ($p < .05$) and the gap between AI condition and Tandem condition was also significant ($p < .01$). However, the discrepancy between Self condition and Tandem condition was not significant. There was no significant main effect on writing credibility, behavioral trust, persistence in the anagram task, and the number of words in prompts (see Figure 1).

2.5.2 Mediation Analysis. According to PROCESS Macro Model 4, perceived identity reflection mediated the relationship between the level of GenAI use and the persistence in anagram task with AI condition as a reference group (Self [vs. AI]: $B = 0.07$, $SE = 0.04$, 95% $CI [0.01, 0.15]$; Tandem [vs. AI]: $B = 0.07$, $SE = 0.04$,

95% $CI [0.01, 0.15]$). According to the analysis, the Self and Tandem conditions showed a higher level of perceived identity reflection than the AI condition, and this perceived identity reflection was positively associated with the persistence in the anagram task (see Figure 2). Simply put, users’ involvement in the content creation increased the level of identification with the essay, and it led participants to spend much time on the unsolvable anagram task. Participants who fully relied on GenAI were less likely to identify with the content, leading them to spend less time on the unsolvable anagram task than other conditions with users’ involvement (i.e., Self and Tandem). The relationships between variables was significant, but their directions were the opposite to our expectation. Thus, H1 was not supported.

Furthermore, perceived identity reflection mediated the relationship between source of writing task and credibility, when AI condition was a reference group (Self [vs. AI]: $B = 0.88$, $SE = 0.32$, 95% $CI [0.29, 1.55]$; Tandem [vs. AI]: $B = 0.93$, $SE = 0.29$, 95% $CI [0.40, 1.53]$). Compared to AI condition, Self and Tandem conditions showed a higher level of perceived identity reflection, and this perceived identity reflection was positively related to writing credibility (see Figure 3). That is, greater user involvement in the writing task enhanced their sense of identification with the essay, leading to more positive attitudes toward the created content. Participants who fully relied on GenAI were less likely to identify with the content, which led to less favorable attitudes toward the created material compared to other conditions involving user participation (i.e., Self and Tandem). Thus, H2a was supported.

In addition, perceived identity reflection also mediated the relation between the level of GenAI use and behavioral trust toward AI (Tandem [vs. AI]: $B = 0.47$, $SE = 0.15$, 95% $CI [0.20, 0.79]$) (see Figure 4). Participants in the Tandem condition perceived that the essay as more reflective of their identity, which, in turn, led to stronger trust in AI. Participants were more likely to trust AI when they identified themselves with the essay because of the symbiotic use of AI. Therefore, H2b was supported.

However, there was no indirect effect on the number of words in the prompts. Thus, H3 was not supported.

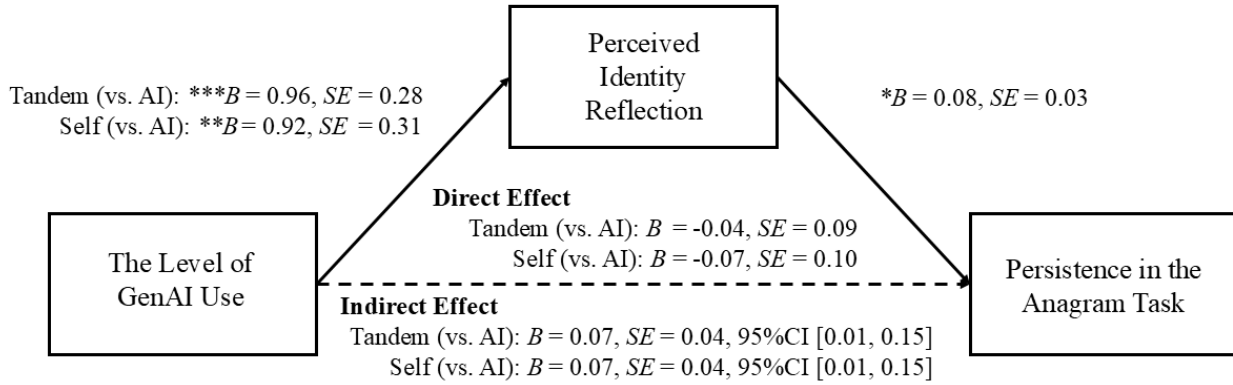


Figure 2: Mediation Between Level of GenAI Use and Persistence in the Anagram Task. Significance level: $*p < .05$, $**p < .01$, $***p < .001$

3 Study 2

Study 1 revealed that increased perceived identity reflection could lead to increased positive attitudes toward the created content and AI, when individuals conduct the Be-task by themselves or assisted by AI. Yet, contrary to our initial hypothesis, conducting a Be-task on their own or in tandem with AI led to higher persistence in anagram via increased identity reflection. The unexpected results could be due to the low external validity of the Be-task. Thus, in Study 2, we conducted an identical experiment with a different depletion manipulation task, which was expected to enhance external and ecological validity of the study design.

3.1 Participants

Study 2 recruited 118 participants from Prolific who live in the US. One participant was excluded from data analysis because of the duration of completion based on the z-score as we did in Study 1 ($N = 117$). Among the participants, 41.9 percent identified as male, while 54.7 percent identified as female. Additionally, 2.6 percent identified as non-binary, and 0.9 percent preferred not to disclose their gender. In terms of race, 45.3 percent identified as White, while 47.9 percent identified as Black or African American. 2.6 percent of participants identified themselves as Asian and 0.9 percent identified as Native American or Alaska Native. 3.4 percent of participants answered Other. Participants' ages ranged from 19 to 72, with an average age of 31.99 years ($SD = 11.96$).

3.2 Measures

Study 2 used identical measures to Study 1: Perceived Identity Reflection ($M = 4.80$, $SD = 0.94$, $\alpha = .74$). Writing Credibility ($M = 5.83$, $SD = 0.95$, $\alpha = .86$). Behavioral Trust ($M = 5.36$, $SD = 1.51$, $\alpha = .94$). Persistence in an Unsolvable Anagram ($M = 1.81$, $SD = 0.41$). Number of Words in Prompts ($M = 16.84$, $SD = 26.01$).

3.3 Experimental Procedure

After consenting to participate, to manipulate resource depletion, participants were presented with a scenario involving a family member's health issue. They were instructed to write an email explaining the situation, detailing their plan to manage work responsibilities during their absence, and seeking the supervisor's understanding and support for the necessary leave. There were no additional restrictions, as writing a hard request for a difficult person was expected to be cognitively demanding on its own (even in a hypothetical setting). Same as Study 1, participants were assigned to either Self, AI, or Tandem conditions. After completing the same tasks as in Study 1, all participants answered the identical questionnaire with the only modification in the measures being the replacement of 'essay' with 'email'.

3.4 Results

Results of Study 2 were also analyzed with a series of ANOVAs and PROCESS Macro Model 4. The p-values of the post-hoc tests were adjusted using the Bonferroni Correction.

3.4.1 Main Effects. According to a series of ANOVAs, the use of GenAI in the writing task showed a significant effect on the email credibility $F(2, 114) = 4.70$, $p = .01$, $partial \eta^2 = .08$. Participants in Tandem group showed the highest level of credibility toward the email ($M = 6.14$, $SD = 0.68$), and participants in Self ($M = 5.85$, $SD = 0.68$) and AI followed ($M = 5.49$, $SD = 1.29$). The difference between AI condition and Tandem condition was significant ($p < .01$). However, there was no significant main effect on perceived identity reflection, behavioral trust, persistence in the unsolvable anagram, and the number of words in prompts. (see Figure 5).

3.4.2 Mediation Analysis. According to PROCESS Macro Model 4, however, there was no indirect effect on credibility, behavioral trust toward AI, persistence on the anagram task, and number of words in prompts through perceived identity reflection. Thus, H1 to H3 were not supported.

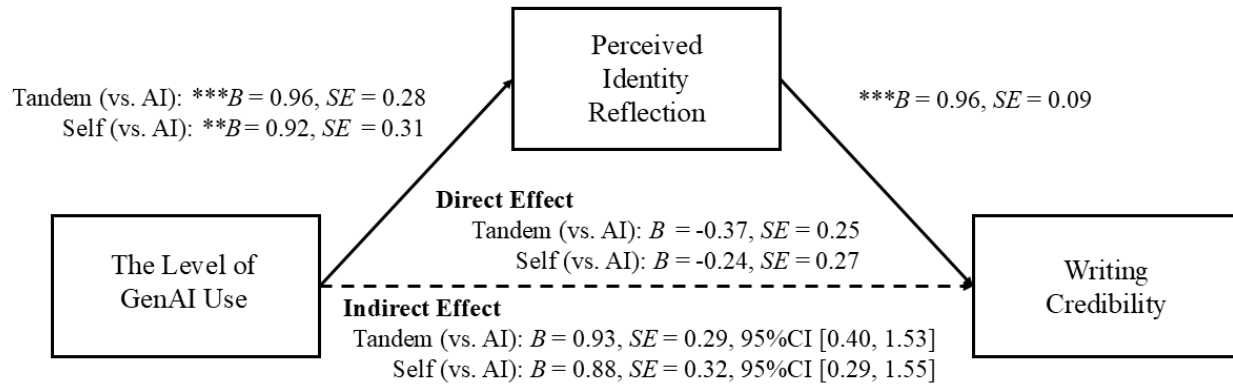


Figure 3: Mediation Between Level of GenAI Use and Writing Credibility. Significance level: $*p < .05$, $**p < .01$, $***p < .001$

4 Discussion

The current study explored if the level of GenAI use in content creation is related to the depletion of self-control resources (i.e., ego depletion) and how the level of cognitive resources affects their prompting behaviors. Study 1 implemented a Be-task to deplete the cognitive resource level. It revealed that using GenAI in creating content decreased perceived identity reflection. Furthermore, the perceived identity reflection positively mediated the relationship between the level of GenAI use and the persistence of anagram tasks, the credibility of written content, and behavioral trust toward AI. However, these findings were not replicated in Study 2, which employed an email writing task, rather than Be-task to deplete the cognitive resources. These results of identification suggest theoretical and practical implications.

4.1 Positive Effect of User Involvement in Creating Content on Identification with Generated Content

First, this study reaffirmed the positive effects of user involvement in AI content creation on users' identification with the resulting content. Aligning with previous studies, our study showed that the level of users' involvement during AI content creation significantly increased users' identification with the resulting content. For example, prior research suggested that customization—tailoring content to users' preferences based on their choices [30]—can enhance users' sense of identity with customized content [13]. In other words, the perception of investing resources in interacting with AI reshapes users' evaluation of the AI's performance [28]. This insight suggests that AI developers, particularly those designing user experiences (UX) and user interfaces (UI), can enhance engagement by creating interfaces that make users feel the content is genuinely shaped by their prompts. UX/UI designers for AI may need to ensure that their AI platform conveys messages encouraging users to engage more and put in greater effort, as this can enhance attitudinal responses toward both the outcomes and AI itself.

4.2 Facilitation Effect of Perceived Identity Reflection on the Persistence

According to the theory of ego depletion, AI condition participants should spend more time on the unsolvable anagram due to conserved self-control resources [4]. However, the opposite pattern emerged in Study 1 as both Self and Tandem conditions led to spending more time than those in the AI condition via perceived identity reflection. Indeed, a similar pattern was observed in Kang and Sundar's [13] study, where, as in our study, increased perceived identity in content customization led to greater persistence on the anagram task. One possible explanation for this interesting pattern is the facilitation effect of perceived identity reflection on persistence through self-esteem. Research indicates that a heightened sense of identity can enhance self-esteem [27], and higher self-esteem has been shown to foster greater persistence [26]. Thus, it is possible that the heightened perceived identity in our study may have increased persistence on unsolvable anagrams via elevated self-esteem.

The other possibility is task similarity. A recent study on ego depletion suggests that task similarity may facilitate performance in self-control tasks [24]. This suggests that tasks involving identity reflection with writing may share similarities with an unsolvable anagram, a common measure of ego depletion [5], which in turn facilitates persistence on such tasks. Furthermore, another potential explanation is the name-letter effect—the tendency to evaluate the letters in one's own name more favorably [21]. The name-letter effect is also used as an implicit measure of self-esteem, which is closely tied to one's sense of identity [12]. If participants with heightened self-identity recognized letters from their own names in the anagram task, it could explain why they spent more time on the task in our study. Thus, future studies also need to investigate it with different sorts of tasks measuring participants' residual self-control resources.

4.3 User Involvement and GenAI Prompting

Furthermore, the number of words in prompting was not impacted by the level of use of GenAI. While there was not a significant

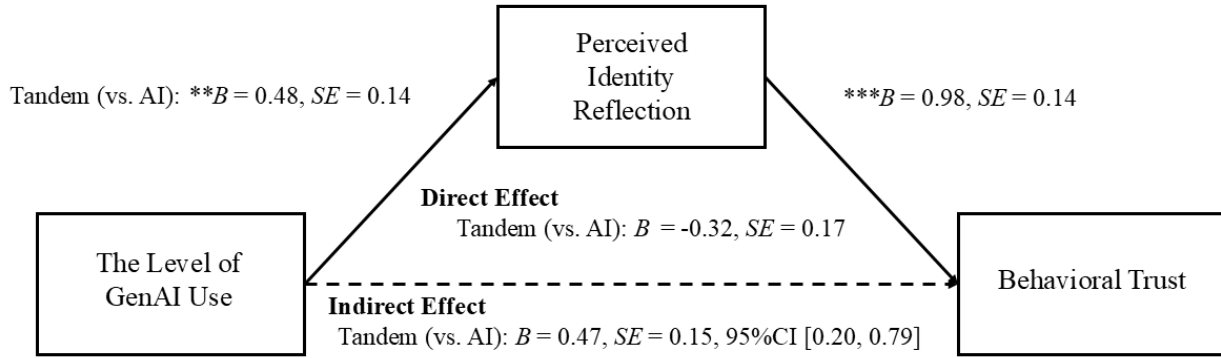


Figure 4: Mediation Between Level of GenAI Use and Behavioral Trust. Significance level: * $p < .05$, ** $p < .01$, *** $p < .001$

difference in the number of words in prompting between Self and Tandem conditions, this non-significance may not be induced by their energy level but induced by their motivation, considering there was an indirect effect of users' efforts (AI vs. Tandem) on the persistence in the anagram task. Simply put, both the AI and Tandem conditions utilized GenAI, which may have primarily satisfied participants, leading them to no longer want to engage in prompting. If this holds true, practitioners could apply this finding to alert GenAI's imperfection to users who fully depend on GenAI without scrutiny, while the created content seems perfect. To this end, future studies could also utilize this finding to investigate whether individuals who have used GenAI in content creation (in the experiment) can recognize more errors in the output of GenAI compared to participants who did not use AI in the tasks.

4.4 Credibility and Identification with AI-Generated Content

In addition, when identification occurs, they are more likely to feel credibility toward the content and use the GenAI in the future. Since individuals were fully involved in the writing process, they could feel an attachment to it [15]. This finding reinforces that identification with content can increase attitudes towards content and the source of content [19, 20]. Practitioners could apply this finding to interface design to improve credibility toward the generated content by letting users feel their agency [25].

4.5 Implementation of the Be-Task

One of the unique contributions of our study is the development of the Be-task. In ego depletion studies, it is common to use the letter "e" task, which requires participants to avoid words containing "e," demanding continuous cognitive control [11]. [11], but this is hard to implement in AI-assisted writing because of the way LLMs tokenize words (e.g., GPT-4 breaks "strawberry" into "st", "raw", and "berry") and thus struggle with letter-based restrictions [8]. To address this, we developed the Be-task, which prohibits "be" verbs (e.g., "is," "was," "are"), maintaining the inhibitory demands of the letter "e" task while being compatible with AI-assisted writing. We

hope this method will be adopted in future ego depletion studies involving AI-assisted writing.

4.6 Practical Implications

This study offers several important implications for AI developers, designers, and professional users. Our findings indicate that users' sense of "seeing themselves" in AI-generated content—what we term perceived identity reflection—plays a significant role in boosting trust and satisfaction. This highlights the need for AI interfaces or workflows that actively invite meaningful user input [34]. By fostering opportunities for users to incorporate their style and ideas, AI systems can enhance the perceived connection between users and the final output. For example, UX/UI designers could create interfaces that promote user input to customize GenAI settings (e.g., tone adjustment in Microsoft Copilot). Additionally, practitioners are also encouraged to enhance users' sense of agency by providing multiple response options (e.g., ChatGPT's response variations), fostering greater identification with the generated content.

Additionally, this study emphasizes the importance of maintaining human involvement to preserve users' cognitive resources and encourage them to utilize those reserved resources for prompting. Prompting users to make edits, revisions, or additional contributions to AI-generated outputs can help counteract concerns about "over-trust" in AI while ensuring that users feel agency over the creative process [6]. Encouraging users to contribute more of their own input to AI-driven tasks not only reduces skepticism about synthetic media but also fosters greater confidence in their outputs [6]. Future AI systems could be designed to encourage such engagement by providing reminders or scaffolding mechanisms that motivate users to iteratively improve their content. This ongoing engagement could further deepen their sense of ownership and lead to improved content quality. Given that this prompting encouragement could be more effective for users who are more involved in the generation process, it is also important to ensure that the generation process, using contingent interaction [10], runs smoothly so that the prompting process is not hindered.

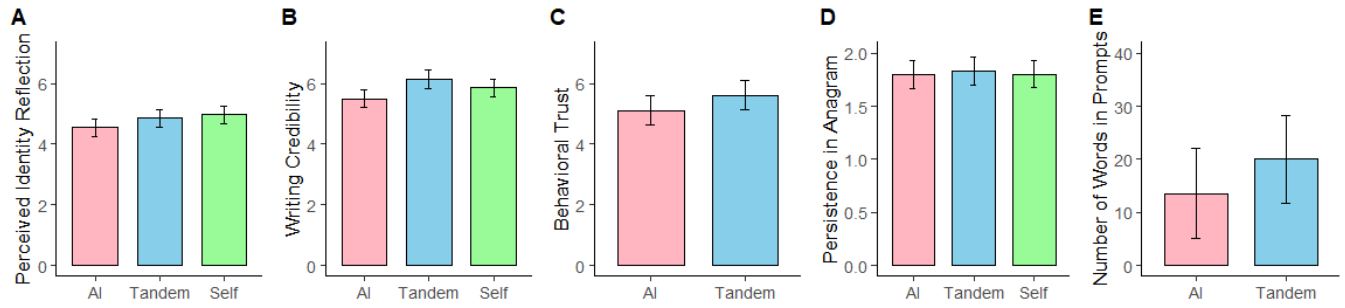


Figure 5: Study 2 Results. Values are estimated marginal means of the measures by experimental conditions. Error bars indicate 95% confidence interval.

Finally, our findings suggest that stakeholders—such as teachers, managers, or decision-makers selecting AI tools—should prioritize systems that facilitate user input. Platforms that encourage users to invest effort and reflect their individuality can foster greater trust and confidence, particularly in contexts where authenticity and long-term engagement are critical. While requiring users to provide additional input may be seen as tedious and inconvenient for professional workers, organizations and educators implementing such tools might find them especially valuable for enhancing both user experience and the outcomes of AI-driven workflows.

4.7 Limitation and Future Research

Our study is not without limitations. First, it should be noted that the setting of our studies diverges from typical, everyday human-AI writing interactions, as we used highly constrained GenAI model parameters and the specific Be-task, which restricts the use of the “be” verb. While these restrictions were strategically imposed to maintain experimental control and isolate the ego depletion effects of GenAI, they also limit the ecological validity of our findings. Future research should explore more naturalistic parameter settings and relaxed task rules, which would help validate and extend our results to reflect real-world collaborative writing processes better.

Another limitation of our study is that the participants’ cognitive demands on performing the Be-task might have varied based on their language proficiency. Even though writers have high language proficiency, those with native proficiency might find avoiding “be” verbs more intuitive than those with professional proficiency, who may experience greater cognitive strain. In our study, while we restricted our participants to those who reside in the US, we did not differentiate the type of proficiency. Future research should explore how language proficiency influences the effectiveness of the Be-task in inducing cognitive depletion and whether task difficulty should be adjusted to ensure comparable cognitive demands across different proficiency levels.

5 Conclusion

In conclusion, this study underscores the importance of designing AI experiences that promote genuine user involvement. By fostering user involvement, encouraging deeper identification with

AI-generated content, promoting iterative engagement, and enabling user agency, such approaches can strengthen trust in AI systems and lead to higher-quality outcomes preventing over-trust on automated processes.

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